THE RIG VEDIC AGE (EARLY VEDIC)

RIG VEDA AS SOURCE → SAPTA-SINDHU TEXTUAL GEOGRAPHY → KIN POLITY: AUTHORITY WITHOUT → CATTLE-AGRICULTURE ECONOMY LOOP → SOCIETY: KINSHIP, DIFFERENCE AND → DEITIES, RITA, YAJNA AND

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g14 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

RIG VEDA AS SOURCE AND CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE

RIG VEDA AS SOURCE AND CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE · FAMILY BOOKS (2-7) · OTHER LAYERS (1, 8, 9, 10) · REDACTION/ORAL PRESERVATION EARLIER CORE TRENDS VARIED/LATER MATERIAL DISCIPLINED TRANSMISSION · WORKING EARLY VEDIC HORIZON · BROADLY C. 1500-1000 BCE, NOT A DATE FOR EVERY · TEXT GIVES A POETIC-RITUAL WORLD: FREQUENCY AND SILENCE ARE

FAMILY BOOKS (2-7) → OTHER LAYERS (1, 8, 9, 10) → REDACTION/ORAL PRESERVATION earlier core → Working early Vedic horizon: broadly c. 1500-1000 BCE, not a date for every hymn. → Text gives a poetic-ritual world; frequency and silence are not census data.

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- FAMILY BOOKS (2-7) → OTHER LAYERS (1, 8, 9, 10) → REDACTION/ORAL PRESERVATION earlier core trends varied/later material disciplined transmission
- Working early Vedic horizon: broadly c. 1500-1000 BCE, not a date for every hymn.

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- Text gives a poetic-ritual world: frequency and silence are not census data.
- FAMILY BOOKS (2-7) → OTHER LAYERS (1, 8, 9, 10) → REDACTION/ORAL PRESERVATION earlier core trends varied/later material disciplined transmission

IMPACT / LIMIT

- Working early Vedic horizon: broadly c. 1500-1000 BCE, not a date for every hymn.
- Text gives a poetic-ritual world; frequency and silence are not census data.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Text gives a poetic-ritual world; frequency and silence are not census data.

01

STAGE 01

SAPTA-SINDHU TEXTUAL GEOGRAPHY

SAPTA-SINDHU TEXTUAL GEOGRAPHY · NORTH-WESTERN MILIEU · KABUL/KUBHA ---- INDUS/SINDHU ---- PUNJAB RIVERS ---- SARASVATI/DRISHADVATI ZONE · RIVERS ORGANISE PRAISE, MOVEMENT, PASTURE AND CONFLICT; GEOGRAPHY IS · GANGA IS MARGINAL IN THIS HORIZON; LATER VEDIC EXPANSION · DO NOT TURN REMEMBERED RIVERS INTO PRECISE POLITICAL BORDERS.

NORTH-WESTERN MILIEU

Kabul/Kubha ---- Indus/Sindhu ---- Punjab rivers ---- Sarasvati/Drishadvati zone mountain routes trunk river pastoral/farming eastern → Rivers organise praise, movement, pasture and conflict; geography is selective. → Ganga is marginal in this horizon; later Vedic expansion shifts the centre east.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- NORTH-WESTERN MILIEU
- Kabul/Kubha ---- Indus/Sindhu ---- Punjab rivers ---- Sarasvati/Drishadvati zone mountain routes trunk river pastoral/farming eastern attention

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Rivers organise praise, movement, pasture and conflict; geography is selective.
- Ganga is marginal in this horizon; later Vedic expansion shifts the centre east.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Do not turn remembered rivers into precise political borders.
- NORTH-WESTERN MILIEU

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Do not turn remembered rivers into precise political borders.

02

STAGE 02

KIN POLITY: AUTHORITY WITHOUT TERRITORIAL STATE

KIN POLITY · AUTHORITY WITHOUT TERRITORIAL STATE · WAR LEADERSHIP; PROTECTION, DISTRIBUTION AND RITUAL STATUS; NOT ABSOLUTE · SMALLER/SELECT ASSEMBLY CONTEXT · BROADER ASSEMBLY PUROHITA · MARTIAL ROLE · GROUP LEADER · OFFERING/TRIBUTE, NOT A REGULAR LAND-REVENUE BUREAUCRACY

KULA → GRAMA → VIS → JANA → RAJAN: war leadership, protection, distribution and ritual status; not absolute monarch sabha: smaller/select assembly context → samiti: broader assembly purohita: adviser → senani: martial role → gramani: group leader

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- KULA → GRAMA → VIS → JANA
- RAJAN: war leadership, protection, distribution and ritual status; not absolute monarch sabha: smaller/select assembly context
- samiti: broader assembly purohita: adviser

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- senani: martial role
- gramani: group leader
- bali: offering/tribute, not a regular land-revenue bureaucracy

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Power rested on kin support, cattle, gifts, assemblies and successful leadership.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Power rested on kin support, cattle, gifts, assemblies and successful leadership.

03

STAGE 03

CATTLE-AGRICULTURE ECONOMY LOOP

CATTLE-AGRICULTURE ECONOMY LOOP · PASTURE + WATER · CATTLE WEALTH · DAIRY, TRACTION, GIFTS, STATUS AND CONFLICT MIXED FARMING · BARLEY/YAVA + CULTIVATION + CRAFTS + EXCHANGE + HOUSEHOLD · PASTORAL PREDOMINANCE DOES NOT MEAN ABSENCE OF AGRICULTURE OR.

PASTURE + WATER → CATTLE WEALTH → dairy, traction, gifts, status and conflict mixed farming → + cultivation + crafts + exchange + household production mobility and raiding settlement and seasonal → Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- PASTURE + WATER → CATTLE WEALTH → dairy, traction, gifts, status and conflict mixed farming: barley/yava
- + cultivation + crafts + exchange + household production mobility and raiding settlement and seasonal cropping

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.
- PASTURE + WATER → CATTLE WEALTH → dairy, traction, gifts, status and conflict mixed farming: barley/yava

DEBATE / LEGACY

- + cultivation + crafts + exchange + household production mobility and raiding settlement and seasonal cropping
- Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.

04

STAGE 04

SOCIETY: KINSHIP, DIFFERENCE AND PROJECTION LIMITS

KINSHIP, DIFFERENCE AND PROJECTION LIMITS · HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER PATRILINEAL MARRIAGE PATRON-CLIENT DASA/DASYU STATUS GROUPS TENDENCY · PURUSHA SUKTA IS LATE IN THE CORPUS; LATER JATI · HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER PATRILINEAL MARRIAGE

HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER patrilineal marriage patron-client dasa/dasyu status groups tendency alliances gift ties varied terms priests/warriors/commoners

Purusha Sukta is late in the corpus; later jati cannot be back-projected.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER patrilineal marriage patron-client dasa/dasyu status groups tendency alliances gift ties varied terms priests/warriors/commoners
- Purusha Sukta is late in the corpus; later jati cannot be back-projected.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER patrilineal marriage patron-client dasa/dasyu status groups tendency alliances gift ties varied terms priests/warriors/commoners
- Purusha Sukta is late in the corpus; later jati cannot be back-projected.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER patrilineal marriage patron-client dasa/dasyu status groups tendency alliances gift ties varied terms priests/warriors/commoners
- Purusha Sukta is late in the corpus; later jati cannot be back-projected.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Purusha Sukta is late in the corpus; later jati cannot be back-projected.

05

STAGE 05

DEITIES, RITA, YAJNA AND SOMA

DEITIES, RITA, YAJNA AND SOMA · ORDERED TRUTH AND COSMIC-SOCIAL REGULARITY · PRAISE + OFFERING + PRIESTLY SPEECH · PROTECTION, CATTLE AND VICTORY · RELIGION LINKS ECOLOGY, WARFARE, GIFT ECONOMY AND ORDER; TEMPLES

RITA: ordered truth and cosmic-social regularity → DEITIES: Indra-war/rain → YAJNA: praise + offering + priestly speech → protection, cattle and victory → Religion links ecology, warfare, gift economy and order; temples are not central.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- RITA: ordered truth and cosmic-social regularity
- DEITIES: Indra-war/rain

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- YAJNA: praise + offering + priestly speech → protection, cattle and victory
- Religion links ecology, warfare, gift economy and order; temples are not central.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- RITA: ordered truth and cosmic-social regularity
- DEITIES: Indra-war/rain

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religion links ecology, warfare, gift economy and order; temples are not central.

06

STAGE 06

CONFLICT, TECHNOLOGY AND CULTURAL INTERACTION

CONFLICT, TECHNOLOGY AND CULTURAL INTERACTION · HORSE/CHARIOT + BOWS/WEAPONS + MOBILE WAR BANDS CATTLE RAIDS · TEXTUAL CHARIOT TERMS MATTER; ARCHAEOLOGICAL CORRELATION REMAINS INDEPENDENT. · CONTESTS + DASHARAJNA COALITION CONFLICT LEADERSHIP AND PRESTIGE CONTACT

horse/chariot + bows/weapons + mobile war bands cattle raids + route/pasture → contests + Dasharajna coalition conflict leadership and prestige contact and incorporation → Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- horse/chariot + bows/weapons + mobile war bands cattle raids + route/pasture
- contests + Dasharajna coalition conflict leadership and prestige contact and incorporation

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.
- horse/chariot + bows/weapons + mobile war bands cattle raids + route/pasture

DEBATE / LEGACY

- contests + Dasharajna coalition conflict leadership and prestige contact and incorporation
- Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.

07

STAGE 07

EARLY TO LATER VEDIC TRANSFORMATION

EARLY TO LATER VEDIC TRANSFORMATION · EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC NORTH-WEST/SAPTA-SINDHU UPPER GANGA-YAMUNA AND EASTWARD · CUMULATIVE TRANSFORMATION WITH REGIONAL VARIATION, NOT ABRUPT RUPTURE. · JANAPADA, STRONGER MONARCHY AND RATNINS CATTLE-CENTRED MIXED ECONOMY PLOUGH

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC north-west/Sapta-Sindhu upper Ganga-Yamuna and eastward movement jana and kin leadership	differentiation firmer varna/patriarchy and gotra deity praise and yajna royal ritual and Upanishadic questioning	EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC north-west/Sapta-Sindhu upper Ganga-Yamuna and eastward movement jana and kin leadership
janapada, stronger monarchy and ratnins cattle-centred mixed economy plough agriculture, surplus and crafts fluid	VERDICT: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.	janapada, stronger monarchy and ratnins cattle-centred mixed economy plough agriculture, surplus and crafts fluid

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC north-west/Sapta-Sindhu upper Ganga-Yamuna and eastward movement jana and kin leadership
- janapada, stronger monarchy and ratnins cattle-centred mixed economy plough agriculture, surplus and crafts fluid

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- differentiation firmer varna/patriarchy and gotra deity praise and yajna royal ritual and Upanishadic questioning
- VERDICT: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC north-west/Sapta-Sindhu upper Ganga-Yamuna and eastward movement jana and kin leadership
- janapada, stronger monarchy and ratnins cattle-centred mixed economy plough agriculture, surplus and crafts fluid

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.

08

STAGE 08

RIG VEDIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

RIG VEDIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE · 10 MARKS · SOURCE CAUTION · HYMN TERM · 15 MARKS · ARCHAEOLOGY CAUTION · 20 MARKS · KIN SYSTEM

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- 10 MARKS: source caution → institution/economy → hymn term → qualification
- 15 MARKS: geography → polity → economy → society → religion → archaeology caution

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 20 MARKS: corpus/layers → Sapta-Sindhu → kin system → cattle-agriculture loop
- differentiation → ritual worldview → conflict/contact → transition

DEBATE / LEGACY

- AVOID: nomad-only, caste-complete, state/empire or homogeneous-date claims.
- CLOSE: a layered pastoral-agricultural kin society undergoing differentiation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: source caution → institution/economy → hymn term → qualification.

09

STAGE 09

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL

EVIDENCE LADDER AND CONFIDENCE CONTROL · EVIDENCE LADDER · FROM SOURCE BOOK · STANDARD KNOWLEDGE · CURRENT AFFAIRS · 2. CLAIM NAMED EVIDENCE SIGNIFICANCE LIMITATION · 3. ASSESS THE USEFULNESS AND LIMITS OF THE RIG · SOURCE TYPE CONTROLS THE STRENGTH AND LIMITS OF THE

SOURCE / MATERIAL	METHOD / DEBATE	HISTORICAL RESULT
EVIDENCE LADDER	2. Claim Named evidence Significance Limitation	VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.
1. = from source book = inference / standard knowledge = current affairs.	3. Assess the usefulness and limits of the Rig Veda as a source for...	EVIDENCE LADDER

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- EVIDENCE LADDER
- 1. = from source book = inference / standard knowledge = current affairs.

METHOD / DEBATE

- 2. Claim Named evidence Significance Limitation
- 3. Assess the usefulness and limits of the Rig Veda as a source for...

HISTORICAL RESULT

- VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.
- EVIDENCE LADDER

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

10

STAGE 10

EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES

EXAMINER TRAPS AND CONTESTED BOUNDARIES · CLOSE DISTINCTIONS · 1. EVIDENCE DISCIPLINE · NO CURRENT-AFFAIRS CLAIM IS FORCED INTO THIS · 2. CONTESTED ISSUES COMPETING INTERPRETATIONS ARE ATTRIBUTED, EVIDENCED · 3. INSCRIPTION AND COIN EVIDENCE · CONTEMPORARY NAMES, TITLES, CLAIMS AND · QUALIFICATION EARNS MARKS; FALSE CERTAINTY IS A HARD FAILURE.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
CLOSE DISTINCTIONS	2. Contested issues Competing interpretations are attributed, evidenced...	VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.
1. Evidence discipline: no current-affairs claim is forced into this...	3. Inscription and coin evidence: contemporary names, titles, claims and...	CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- CLOSE DISTINCTIONS
- 1. Evidence discipline: no current-affairs claim is forced into this...

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 2. Contested issues Competing interpretations are attributed, evidenced...
- 3. Inscription and coin evidence: contemporary names, titles, claims and...

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.
- CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.

11

STAGE 11

INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

INTEGRATED ANSWER SPINE AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION · ANSWER SPINE · 1. BASIC COMPLETENESS · SUBSTANTIVE OWNER MATERIAL IS RETAINED IN A · 2. ORIGINAL SOLVED 10-MARK MAINS 2 · 3. ORIGINAL SOLVED 15-MARK MAINS 2 · CLAIM, NAMED EVIDENCE, ANALYSIS AND QUALIFICATION LEAD TO A

ANSWER SPINE → 1. Basic completeness: substantive owner material is retained in a → 2. Original solved 10-mark Mains 2 → 3. Original solved 15-mark Mains 2 → VERDICT: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- ANSWER SPINE
- 1. Basic completeness: substantive owner material is retained in a...

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 2. Original solved 10-mark Mains 2
- 3. Original solved 15-mark Mains 2

DEBATE / LEGACY

- VERDICT: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded...
- ANSWER SPINE

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · OPTIONAL ADVANCED ORIENTATION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] · A1. TEXTUAL STRATIFICATION AND ORAL-FORMULAIC METHOD — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] · A2. GIFT ECONOMY AND REDISTRIBUTION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] · A3. INDO-IRANIAN RELIGIOUS COMPARISON — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] · A4. DASA/DASYU, VARNA AND BOUNDARY-MAKING — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] · A5. HOUSEHOLD, GENDER, FUNERAL AND PHILOSOPHICAL MATERIAL — [OPTIONAL] · A6. ARCHAEOLOGY, HORSE AND CHARIOT LIMITS — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Optional Advanced Orientation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A1. Textual Stratification and Oral-Formulaic Method — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A2. Gift Economy and Redistribution — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A3. Indo-Iranian Religious Comparison — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

ADVANCED DEBATE

- A4. Dasa/Dasyu, Varna and Boundary-Making — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A5. Household, Gender, Funeral and Philosophical Material — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A6. Archaeology, Horse and Chariot Limits — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A7. Historical Memory and Historiography — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

LEGACY / NUANCE

- Advanced Evidence Clinics: Applying the Limits — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- Optional Advanced Orientation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] The following material enriches the core
- session but is not required for a competent Prelims or Mains answer.
- Oral stability can preserve archaic language, while composition and transmission still create layers.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels